

State of Meridian

Employment & Data Protection Act, 2025

Statute Reference: SM-EDPA-2025 | Effective Date: 1 March 2025 | Jurisdiction: State of Meridian | Applies to: All employers with 10+ employees operating within the state

Section 1 — Working Hours & Overtime

- 1.1** Standard working hours shall not exceed 8 hours per day or 40 hours per week.
- 1.2** Any work beyond standard hours must be compensated at 1.5x the regular hourly rate, with written employee consent.
- 1.3** Employers must maintain digital attendance records accessible to labor inspectors upon request.

Section 2 — Leave Entitlements

- 2.1** Employers must provide a minimum of 21 days of paid annual leave per year.
- 2.2** A minimum of 12 days of paid sick leave must be granted annually, without mandatory medical certification for absences of 1-2 days.
- 2.3** Employers must additionally provide 5 days of paid bereavement leave per calendar year.
- 2.4** Parental leave of at least 26 weeks must be provided to primary caregivers.

Section 3 — Workplace Conduct & Anti-Harassment

- 3.1** Employers must establish an Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) and resolve harassment complaints within 90 days.
- 3.2** Mandatory anti-harassment training must be conducted for all employees at least once every 12 months.
- 3.3** Employers must display the anti-harassment policy prominently at all workplace locations.
- 3.4** Whistleblower protections must be provided to employees reporting violations in good faith, including protection from termination or demotion.

Section 4 — Data Protection Requirements

- 4.1** Personal data of employees and customers must be processed only with a documented lawful basis (consent, contract, or legal obligation).
- 4.2** Any data breach affecting personal data must be reported to the State Data Protection Authority within **72 hours** of discovery.
- 4.3** Affected individuals must be notified of a data breach without undue delay if it poses a high risk to their rights.
- 4.4** Data subjects have the right to request access to, correction of, and erasure of their personal data ("right to be forgotten").
- 4.5** Employers must appoint a designated Data Protection Officer (DPO) if processing personal data at scale.
- 4.6** Personal data must not be retained beyond the period necessary for the purpose it was collected, and retention schedules must be documented.

Section 5 — Remote & Distributed Work

- 5.1** Employers permitting remote work must provide a written remote work security policy covering device encryption and secure network access.
- 5.2** Employers must reimburse reasonable home-office expenses (internet, equipment) for employees required to work remotely.

Section 6 — Termination & Severance

- 6.1** Minimum notice period for termination without cause is 60 days, or payment in lieu thereof.
- 6.2** Final wage settlement, including any accrued leave encashment, must be completed within 15 days of the last working day.
- 6.3** Employers must provide a written statement of reasons for termination upon employee request.

Enforcement: Non-compliance with any section of this Act may result in penalties ranging from monetary fines to suspension of business operating licenses within the State of Meridian, as determined by the Labor & Data Protection Commission.